

Q.3b (15 marks): How qualitative and quantitative methods supplement each other in anthropological research

How does quantitative and qualitative methods supplement each other in Anthropological research? (15 marks)

Anthropology is the holistic study
of humans in time and space.

It has developed a rich set of both qualitative and quantitative methods to do ethnographic research.

Qualitative Methods

→ they focus on in depth micro-study
of a particular phenomenon or
community.

Examples include

- (a) Observation:
Participant and non-participant observation
- (b) Interview
- (c) Case Study
- (d) Oral history and life history

→ Among qualitative method, observation and particularly participant observation is most widely used.

⇒ It involves researcher going to

the field and participating in day to day customs of natives.

Quantitative methods

→ it focusses on macro study on larger audience

→ Examples include (c) Questionnaire (d) Schedules
(a) Survey method (b) Genealogical method

ways in which Quantitative and Qualitative method supplement each other →

→ usually, a researcher selects one of the qualitative method, for ex. participant observation in the beginning of research.

→ within the ambit of qualitative methods, various quantitative methods are used.

→ for ex. in the ~~field~~ field, researcher

might begin by collecting genealogy
via the genealogical method (quantitative).

→ Then he can use interviews to
understand individual perspective (qualitative)

→ if the area to be studied is
large, schedules may be employed
(quantitative)

→ to further supplement research
and collect additional data apart
from field, questionnaires can be
sent over mail to larger audience
(quantitative).

Thus, a combination of both
quantitative and qualitative methods
can be employed for holistic
research study.